

Your Past Performance Guide

This guide and the templates help you show federal agencies you've done similar work before, which is critical for winning contracts.

What it is. Past performance is how a Contracting Officer (CO) decides if you can actually deliver. They want a concise, one-page summary for each relevant project. It needs to cover the contract, your role, the scope, dollar value, period of performance, and a contact for verification.

When to use it. You'll need these references for most federal proposals, especially for contracts over \$250,000. Start preparing them now, before an RFP drops, because getting client sign-off usually takes time.

How to use it.

- First, read "Turning Commercial Work into Federal Past Performance." It shows you how to frame your non-federal or subcontract work for a federal audience without overstating it.
- Then, use the "Past-Performance Reference (Word)" template. Fill it out for your best projects.
- Send the "Reference Request Letter (Word)" to your past clients. This helps them give you a clean, consistent reference that meets federal expectations.
- Review the "Sample: IT Services" and "Sample: Janitorial" files. They show you what a complete, well-written reference looks like.

Watch out for. Don't just list projects. Make sure each one clearly highlights accomplishments relevant to federal contracting, and always get client approval before submitting their contact info.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/past-performance> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/market-research> (Market Research)